

Bishops need diagonals

Foundations

THE IDEA

A bishop stays on one color throughout the game. It can cross an empty diagonal quickly but cannot jump a blocker. Its value depends on which important squares its color can reach and whether its own pawns obstruct the route.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A bishop on c1 initially faces its own pawns on b2 and d2. Moving the d-pawn can open the c1-h6 diagonal. Moving an unrelated rook pawn does not solve that bishop's development problem.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why can a bishop on c1 never capture a piece on c2?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Those squares have different colors. No sequence of bishop moves changes the bishop's color. Another piece must handle threats on the other color complex.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A bishop plan begins by tracing its usable diagonals.